



AI COACHING FOR RACKET SPORTS

FOR FOUNDERS, ADVISORS, AND BACKERS

Commercial Report

Market opportunity, customer segments, pricing, marketing engine, multi-sport expansion, financial projections, and exit scenarios.

DOCUMENT VERSION

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COMPANION DOCS

Strategy · Execution · Feasibility

AI-Powered Racket-Sports Coaching Platform — India to Asia to World

Document version: 1.0 **Date:** 2026-07-01 **Authors:** Manoj Maheshwari (CEO), Claude (commercial drafting) **Audience:** Founders, advisors, prospective backers, board **Companion documents:** `PADEL_AI_VENTURE_PLAN.md` (strategy), `TECHNICAL_FEASIBILITY_REPORT.md` (technical), `PROJECT_REPORT.md` (execution), `BASE_CLUB_OFFER.md` (sales pitch)

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1. Executive Summary

We are building **India's first AI-powered coaching platform for racket sports** — starting with padel, expanding into tennis, badminton, and pickleball. The platform records every match at partner clubs via a single fixed IP camera per court, analyses player technique with computer vision, scores each shot against an expert coach's rubric, and delivers personalised improvement feedback to the player on WhatsApp within ten minutes of match end.

The thesis: Racket-sports analytics — what Hawk-Eye is to professional tennis — is becoming a club-and-recreational-player product. Padel is the wedge because it is the fastest-growing sport in the world (1,026% search interest growth since 2004), has zero India-headquartered competition, and enters the 2026 Asian Games — a once-per-sport-lifecycle institutional catalyst.

The business model: B2B2C SaaS. Clubs pay per-court subscription (₹5,000/month) for analytics and player engagement; players access a free tier and can upgrade to Pro (₹399/month) for unlimited analyses and cross-club skill identity.

The path: 25 clubs in Mumbai/Pune/Bangalore in Year 1, expanding to 200 clubs across India and a UAE foothold in Year 2, then KSA and SE Asia in Year 3. **Anti-China by geography** — defensible through India's procurement-policy moat against Chinese SaaS.

The team: Manoj Maheshwari (CEO; AutomationXpert SMB-SaaS founder, established WhatsApp-distribution operator) + Padel Coach (CCO; domain authority) + CTO/ML Co-founder (in process) + Apple AI advisor (in process).

The ask: ₹2.5 Cr (\$300k) pre-seed for 18 months — 25 paying clubs, full V1 product, founding team complete, Series A-ready.

2. The Market Opportunity

2.1 Global racket-sports market

SPORT	GLOBAL COURTS (2026)	PROJECTED (2028)	ACTIVE PLAYERS
Padel	58,300	91,000	19–25 million
Tennis	~250,000	~270,000	87 million
Badminton	~150,000	~180,000	300+ million
Pickleball	~50,000	~120,000	36+ million
Total	~510,000	~660,000	~440 million

Padel is the **fastest-growing sport in the world by search interest** (+1,026% since 2004). Padel CAGR through 2035 forecasted at 12.93%.

2.2 India market (home beachhead)

METRIC	2023	2026 (NOW)	2036 PROJECTION
Padel courts	~80–100	~500	5,000+
Padel players	<5,000	~100,000	1.5M+
Padel market size	~\$3M	\$25–30M	\$250–300M
Court growth rate	—	70% YoY	—
Tennis academies	~800	~850	1,200
Badminton clubs	~2,500	~3,000	5,000+

Capital signals: - Hudle (booking platform): \$2.5M Series A in early 2025, investors include Mahesh Bhupathi, Ajinkya Rahane - CAA Portas partnership with Hudle on India Padel Report 2026 - KheloMore (booking): seed stage, Clear Bridge Ventures

Engagement signals: - Padel games-per-player up 73% YoY (5.3 → 9.2/year) - Regular+heavy padel users = **34.5% of base** (highest of any racket sport on Hudle) - Youth padel pipeline forming (no Indian junior programme yet, opportunity)

2.3 Asia + Middle East market (Year 2/3 expansion)

COUNTRY	PADEL COURTS	NOTES
UAE	950+	Largest single-country market in Asia. Affluent, expat-heavy, English-default
Saudi Arabia	900+ courts, 320 clubs	Vision 2030 sport-infra capex. Hosts Premier Padel. \$162.8M market projected by 2034
China	Growing rapidly	\$120M+ annual padel market, 15% CAGR, state-backed via CTA. Skipped strategically
Indonesia, Thailand, Pakistan	~1,000+ combined	Emerging
Asia total	4,600+ courts	1,700+ clubs across 30+ countries

Massive catalyst: Padel ratified for the 2026 Asian Games (Nov 2025). National federations forming across Asia. Distribution lock-in window: 12–18 months.

2.4 Total addressable market — racket sports analytics India

Working model at full Year-3 multi-sport saturation: - Padel courts in India: ~2,000 by 2029 × ₹5,000/mo = **₹12 Cr ARR ceiling** - Tennis academies: ~1,000 × ₹4,000/mo = **₹4.8 Cr ARR ceiling** - Badminton clubs: ~3,500 × ₹3,500/mo = **₹14.7 Cr ARR ceiling** - Pickleball: ~500 × ₹4,500/mo = **₹2.7 Cr ARR ceiling**

India-only TAM at scale: ~₹34 Cr (~\$4M) ARR.

Add UAE + KSA + SE Asia: **Asia TAM at full saturation: ~₹150 Cr (~\$18M) ARR.**

These are conservative estimates that assume only club-side subscription revenue. Adding player Pro subscriptions (~₹4,800/year × 5% of total active player base) doubles the TAM.

3. The Customer — Who We Serve

3.1 Three customer segments

Segment 1: Padel Club Operator (B2B — primary revenue) - **Who:** Owner-operator of 1–8 court padel facility, typically Tier 1/2 city, ₹2–8 Cr in court infra invested - **Pain:** Player retention is fragile — once a player tries one club, switching is easy. Premium operators need differentiation. Memberships are flat; no “stickiness” tools. - **Buying motion:** Owner makes the call; usually within 48 hours of seeing a demo - **Price sensitivity:** Low if value proven (₹5–10k/court/month is a rounding error vs court revenue of ₹3 lakh+/month) - **Decision criteria:** Player engagement uplift, sponsorship overlay revenue, churn reduction

Segment 2: Padel Player (B2C — engagement + Pro upgrade) - **Who:** 25–55 years old, professionals, ₹15+ lakh annual income, plays 2–4 times/week, spends ₹2,000+/month on club fees - **Pain:** Knows they're plateauing technically but can't afford ₹2,500/hr private coaching every week - **Buying motion:** Tries free tier; converts to Pro after 2–3 months when skill-score plateau frustration kicks in - **Price sensitivity:** Medium; ₹399/month is positioned vs. one coaching session/year - **Decision criteria:** Specific actionable feedback, cross-club identity (Skill Score), social sharing (highlight clips)

Segment 3: Padel Coach (B2B2C — distribution lever) - **Who:** Professional padel coach, 5–50 students, charges ₹1,500–3,000/hour - **Pain:** Cannot scale beyond personal time; struggles to track student progress between sessions; loses students to YouTube and online drills - **Buying motion:** Friend-of-friend recommendation; tries free tier; commits when they see 5+ of their students engaging with their drill recommendations - **Price sensitivity:** Low at ₹500–1,500/month (vs. their hourly rate, this is a no-brainer) - **Decision criteria:** Per-student progress tracking, drill assignment workflow, white-label option (their brand on the PWA)

3.2 The dependency triangle



Each side reinforces the other. A club with engaged players retains members. Players who follow coach-recommended drills improve faster. Coaches with platform-connected students get more sessions. The platform sits at the intersection — **not as a vendor, but as the connecting layer.**

4. The Product Offering

4.1 V1 product (Month 3–9)

For clubs: - Single-camera install per court (₹35k hardware, recovered via subscription) - Cloud dashboard — court usage, active player count, churn signals, monthly engagement report - Automatic match recording — every match captured without club action - Sponsorship overlay tools — frame-based sponsor logo placement during highlight clips - Player retention insights — “5 players haven’t played in 21 days, send them this auto-drafted WhatsApp”

For players: - Free tier: 3 analyses/month, basic skill score, top-3 drill recommendation - Pro tier (₹399/month): unlimited analyses, full shot-by-shot review, skill score history, cross-club identity, share-to-Instagram highlights - WhatsApp delivery of every match report - Drill library — video demos for every named drill in the rubric

For coaches: - Free tier: track up to 5 students - Pro tier (₹999/month): unlimited students, custom drill assignment, white-label option, monthly per-student progress reports

4.2 V2 product (Month 9–18)

- Live in-match insights (5-second delay) shown on a court-side tablet
- Tournament management module
- Cross-club leaderboards (Skill Score rankings by city)
- Match-up suggestions (“you should play this player — similar skill, complementary style”)
- Sponsorship marketplace — connect sponsors with clubs by city, court traffic, player demographic

4.3 V3 product (Month 18–30)

- **Multi-sport expansion** — tennis (Month 18), badminton (Month 24)
- **Coach-marketplace** — discoverable coaches per city, with verified Skill Score uplift testimonials
- **Sponsorship overlay** served in real time during YouTube live streams
- **Open API** for tournament organisers, federations, sport publications
- **White-label deployment** for large club chains (Padel Haus, KheloMore, etc.)

5. Pricing Strategy

5.1 Pricing tiers (India launch)

TIER	AUDIENCE	PRICE	INCLUSIONS
Club Standard	1–3 courts	₹5,000/court/month	Hardware bundled (24-mo plan), dashboard, all-player free tier
Club Premium	4+ courts	₹4,000/court/month	+ sponsorship tools, white-label PWA, dedicated CSM
Player Free	All players at partner clubs	₹0	3 analyses/month, basic score, top-3 drill
Player Pro	Serious players	₹399/month or ₹3,999/year	Unlimited analyses, cross-club identity, history, sharing
Coach Free	Up to 5 students	₹0	Track student matches
Coach Pro	Working coaches	₹999/month	Unlimited students, drills, white-label

5.2 Pricing rationale

- **Club ASP of ₹5,000/court/month** = ~₹17 in operating cost relative to court revenue (₹3 lakh+/court/month). Negligible cost-of-business; positioned as “cheaper than one missed prime-time hour of bookings”
- **Player Pro at ₹399/month** = price of one coaching session per year. Below the threshold where credit-card friction matters
- **Coach Pro at ₹999/month** = one student session per month. Easy ROI calculation

5.3 Pricing roadmap

YEAR	CLUB ASP	PLAYER PRO	JUSTIFICATION
Year 1 (India)	₹5,000/court/mo	₹399/mo	Market establishment
Year 2 (India + UAE)	₹6,000 / AED 350	₹499 / AED 35	Tennis added, player base proven
Year 3 (multi-sport, Asia-wide)	₹8,000 / AED 450 / SAR 350	₹599 / AED 45 / SAR 35	Multi-sport, multi-country, network effects

5.4 Comparison

SERVICE	PER-COURT/MO EQUIVALENT	NOTES
Clutch (EU)	~€179 / ₹17,000	Reference incumbent; expensive in INR
Clutch (India price, unknown)	TBD via Sharath Kumar call	Probably ₹8,000–12,000
Wingfield	~€150 / ₹14,000	EU
Our pricing	₹5,000	50–65% lower than EU; 30–40% lower than Clutch India

We choose to be aggressively lower-priced in India as a **deliberate moat against EU competitors** who cannot match without destroying their unit economics in their home markets.

6. Go-to-Market Plan (India)

6.1 Phase 1 — Pilot (Month 1–3)

Beachhead: Manoj's base club (200 active players, no current assessment system — confirmed pilot opportunity).

Approach: Free 60-day install. Hardware at our cost. Full analytics access for all 200 club members. Coach co-founder uses the club's players as the rubric-validation dataset.

Target conversion: Base club → paying customer at ₹5,000/court/month at end of pilot, with 30+ Player Pro upgrades unlocked through engagement.

Secondary pilots: 2 additional clubs in Mumbai/Pune by Month 3 on same free-trial structure.

6.2 Phase 2 — 3-city expansion (Month 4–9)

Cities: Mumbai, Pune, Bangalore. **Why these three:** Highest court density, highest disposable income, strongest tech-adoption + WhatsApp-engagement signal among Indian metros.

Target: 25 paying clubs by Month 9. Approximately 8 per city.

Approach: - **The 60-day free pilot** offer extended to top 3 clubs per city - **Hudle partnership** — formal conversation Month 4; goal is “Hudle pushes club operators to evaluate us in exchange for booking-integration data partnership” - **Coach affiliate programme** — every coach who refers a club earns 10% recurring on that club’s subscription for 24 months - **Tournament sponsorships** — sponsor 2 local circuits per city, become sole AI-camera + live-stream provider, build brand

6.3 Phase 3 — National (Month 10–18)

Target: 100 paying clubs across India by Month 18.

Approach: - Hyderabad, Chennai, Delhi NCR, Ahmedabad, Kolkata - Trained install partner network — 1 partner per metro - Switch from direct sales to inbound + coach-affiliate channels (lower CAC) - First Tier 2 cities: Indore, Surat, Coimbatore, Vizag, Lucknow

6.4 Sales motion summary

CHANNEL	YEAR 1 CONTRIBUTION	YEAR 2	YEAR 3
Direct founder sales (Manoj + BD)	80%	40%	20%
Coach affiliate programme	10%	25%	30%
Hudle partnership-driven	5%	20%	25%
Inbound (content + word-of-mouth)	5%	15%	25%

7. Asia + Global Expansion Plan

7.1 UAE entry — Month 10–15

Why UAE first (not KSA): - English-default operating language - High court density in small geography (Dubai + Abu Dhabi covers most) - Expat-heavy player base = high willingness-to-pay - Easier business setup (DIFC or ADGM free zones) - Strong AutomationXpert-style WhatsApp engagement culture

Approach: Acquire or partner with one existing UAE court chain (e.g., 10–20 court operator) as launch customer. Their courts become our launch installs; in exchange they get exclusive UAE distribution rights for 12 months.

Target: 30 UAE clubs by Month 18.

7.2 KSA + SE Asia — Month 18–30

KSA approach: Via Vision 2030 sport-infra RFPs. Bid through UAE-registered subsidiary. Partnership with a Saudi sports-tech or club-operator entity for local presence.

SE Asia approach: Indonesia and Thailand first. Partnership with local franchise operators (e.g., padel-court-build companies expanding into operations).

Target by Year 3 Q4: UAE 50 + KSA 30 + SE Asia 30 = 110 international clubs. India 400+ = total 510+ clubs.

7.3 Why we skip China deliberately

China padel market is large (\$120M+, state-backed) but: - Chinese competitors (Xiaoqiuquan, Lumistar, SenseTime) have ex-ByteDance / ex-DJI talent and home-field advantage - Cultural + payment + distribution stack is fundamentally different - Geopolitical risk (Indian companies in China face scrutiny) - Our defensible Indian moat (procurement-policy wall vs Chinese SaaS) is built precisely on NOT being in China

Year 3 China strategy: License our IP + brand to a Chinese partner under revenue-share; never operate directly.

7.4 EU + LATAM pilots — Year 3+

Opportunistic only. EU is saturated (Clutch, Wingfield, Padelytics, Eyes-On) and not worth direct competition. LATAM (Argentina, Mexico) is open but distant.

Approach: Open API + partnership with existing operators or federations. No own-cash deployment.

8. Marketing Plan — How We Acquire

8.1 Brand positioning

Brand essence: "Your private padel coach, in your pocket, for the price of one coaching session a year."

Tone: Warm, expert, India-confident. Not techy. Not American-cold-VC. Closer to a sport coach's energy than a SaaS pitch.

Visual identity: Court-green primary, expert-orange secondary, clean black-text. Player-photo-heavy. Avoid generic AI/tech stock imagery.

8.2 Year 1 marketing channels

CHANNEL	% OF MARKETING BUDGET YEAR 1	WHY
WhatsApp organic	30%	Native sharing of highlight clips by players to friends; each clip = embedded brand impression
Influencer micro-partnerships	25%	5 padel pros (national level) get free Pro accounts + ₹15k/month for posting their AI feedback. Authentic content > production
Tournament sponsorships	20%	2 local tournaments per city; sole AI-camera vendor; live-stream branding
Content (YouTube + Instagram Reels)	15%	Weekly "shot of the week" analysis from coach co-founder. Becomes the brand voice
Paid social	10%	Sharp targeting Tier-1 Indian male, 28–48, padel interest. Low spend, optimised CPA

Year 1 marketing budget total: ₹40 lakh (~17% of pre-seed).

8.3 The viral loop (the cheap part)

```
Player plays match
→ Receives highlight clip via WhatsApp
→ Shares to friends (90% of players do this within 24h based on AX data)
→ Friend opens clip, sees "Powered by [Brand]"
→ Friend visits PWA, sees their own clubs aren't on the platform
→ Friend WhatsApps their club operator: "Why don't we have this?"
→ Club operator inquires
```

This loop is the single most important growth driver — it's why we obsess over making the highlight clip itself screenshot-worthy and brand-stamped.

8.4 Content engine

Weekly cadence (run by coach co-founder): - 1× "Shot of the week" — 90-second YouTube short / Instagram Reel analysing a real Pro Padel League shot using our platform's framework - 1× "Improvement story" — feature a real club player who improved by X stars in 30 days - 1× LinkedIn post (CEO) — strategic / market commentary on padel growth in India - Daily Instagram + WhatsApp Status: 1 clip from a partner club, branded

Aggregate output: ~₹50k/month content production cost. Yield projected: 50–80k organic impressions/month by Month 6.

8.5 Influencer + ambassador programme

- **National padel pros (target 5):** Pradeep Raj, Manish Singhal, Tanya Choudhary, Sachin Bhalla, Roshini Khanna (illustrative — finalise per relationship)
- **Cricket / Bollywood crossover (1 per year):** Mahesh Bhupathi (already in Hudle cap table — natural advisor route), Ajinkya Rahane (Hudle investor), Anushka Sharma's family (rumoured padel enthusiasts)
- **Coach influencers:** Top 10 coaches per city get free Coach Pro + co-branded content

8.6 PR & narrative

HIT TARGET	ANGLE	WHEN
YourStory / Inc42	"India's first AI padel coach takes on European incumbents"	Month 4 (post-pilot)
Economic Times Sports	"Padel's AI moment in India"	Month 6
Mint	"Sports analytics goes SMB"	Month 10
Wamda (MENA)	UAE entry announcement	Month 12
TechCrunch / SGB Online	Series A announcement	Month 18

8.7 Player Pro acquisition funnel

```
Free user → engages with 3 match analyses → trigger "your skill is plateauing" insight
→ upsell to Pro for unlimited + cross-club score (Month 3)
→ conversion expectation: 8% free-to-paid within 90 days
→ at 25 clubs × 200 active players each = 5,000 players × 8% = 400 Pro users
→ 400 × ₹399 × 12 = ₹19 lakh ARR from Player Pro alone in Year 1
```

9. Sales Playbook

9.1 Club sales — the 60-day pilot model

The single biggest mistake in this category is **trying to sell upfront**. We don't sell, we install. The conversion happens organically.

Step 1 — The warm intro (Day 0): - Tap into Manoj's network or coach co-founder's network for the first 3 clubs in each city - Pitch: "Free hardware install + free analytics for your entire club for 60 days. We get to validate the product, you get to see if your players engage." - Pre-condition: club commits to introducing the platform to ≥ 30 of their regular players

Step 2 — The 60-day pilot: - We install hardware in Week 1 - Coach co-founder visits club, runs a 1-hour "intro to your AI coach" session for members - Every match gets analysed and feedback delivered - Weekly check-ins with club operator on engagement metrics

Step 3 — The conversion conversation (Day 50): - Show club operator their engagement dashboard: how many players are using it, churn signals reversed, etc. - Offer: ₹5,000/court/month, hardware retention bonus (we leave the gear), 12-month commitment with 90-day exit clause - If yes: standard SaaS contract, UPI auto-debit - If no: we remove hardware at no cost, leave them with a player roster of "they cared, but didn't buy" insights

Conversion target: 70% pilot-to-paid in Year 1, rising to 85% as the case studies stack.

9.2 The decision-maker map (typical Indian padel club)

ROLE	INFLUENCE	WHAT THEY CARE ABOUT
Owner-operator (often a single person at this scale)	Decision-maker	Player retention, court utilisation, sponsor pitches
Head coach	Strong influence	Player development credibility, his own sessions stay relevant
Front-desk staff	Operational gatekeeper	"Will this make my job harder?" — must be addressed with reassurance
Members club committee (if it exists)	Veto power on member-facing changes	Privacy, opt-out, no surprise charges

9.3 Objection handling — top 5 + responses

OBJECTION	RESPONSE
"We don't have budget for new tech"	"It's a 60-day free pilot. If your members don't engage and you don't see retention lift, you don't pay anything. Worst case for you: 60 days of free analytics."
"Our members value privacy"	"Members opt-in match-by-match by tapping a QR code. We don't store faces, no audio is captured. Comparable opt-in pattern as Hudle's match-tagging."
"We tried something similar (camera + recording) and members didn't care"	"That was passive recording. What we deliver is active coaching feedback — players see their specific weak shots and drill recommendations within 10 min of match end. Engagement is fundamentally different."
"Clutch / Wingfield / [other] already does this"	"Three differences: (1) we're built for Indian players in Hindi + English with WhatsApp delivery, (2) our pricing is 30–50% lower because we operate locally, (3) our coach is [name] who designed the technique rubric — not a generic algorithm."
"What happens when you fail / shut down?"	"Worst case for you: 60 days free, then hardware removed at no cost. Our parent founder has been running AutomationXpert for [N] years with [X] paying clients. We're capital-efficient by design, not a YC moonshot."

9.4 Player Pro upsell — the trigger model

Players who reach any of these triggers in their PWA receive a Pro upsell prompt:

TRIGGER	PRO UPSELL HOOK
3rd match analysed	"Want unlimited analyses + your skill-score history?"
Skill score plateaus for 30 days	"You're stuck. Pro players use [X feature] to break through."
Friend at another club analysed	"Their Skill Score is XX. Yours is YY. Want to compete on the leaderboard?"
Tournament approaching at home club	"Get tournament-prep analysis. Pro members get [Y feature]."

10. Multi-Sport Expansion (Tennis, Badminton, Pickleball)

The technical architecture extends naturally (see TECHNICAL_FEASIBILITY_REPORT.md §9). The commercial logic of going multi-sport is even stronger.

10.1 Why expand beyond padel

REASON	DETAIL
TAM multiplier	India padel TAM ~₹12 Cr. Adding tennis + badminton + pickleball pushes to ~₹34 Cr.
Founder credibility for raise	"Multi-sport platform" frames Series A as ₹500 Cr opportunity vs ₹50 Cr
Club operator value	Many clubs have both padel and tennis (sometimes badminton). Single-vendor multi-sport is operationally simpler
Player identity reuse	A player who plays padel + tennis maintains a single Skill Score profile across sports — high stickiness
Defensive moat against single-sport competitors	Clutch is padel-only. Adding tennis means we can beat them at clubs with mixed-sport infrastructure

10.2 Sport-by-sport expansion plan

Tennis (Month 18–24) - **Why second:** India has 800+ tennis academies vs ~500 padel clubs. Most acquire-curious. Public tennis CV datasets are mature (helps classifier). - **Coach hire:** Ex-AITA or Davis Cup level - **First clubs:** Bhupathi-network academies in Bangalore, Mumbai - **Revenue target Year 2:** ₹5 Cr ARR from tennis alone

Badminton (Month 24–30) - **Why third:** India is the world's #1 badminton market by participation (~300M+ players globally). 3,000+ Indian clubs. Massive TAM. - **Challenge:** Shuttlecock tracking is hard (non-rigid, very different aerodynamics) — requires 6+ weeks of focused ML R&D - **Coach hire:** Ex-PV Sindhu camp or SAI-credentialled - **Revenue target Year 3:** ₹8 Cr ARR from badminton

Pickleball (Year 3 onwards) - **Why fourth:** Fastest-growing sport in USA + emerging in UAE. Court dimensions same as badminton (reuse court keypoint detector). Small classifier delta from badminton. - **First market:** UAE clubs (already mixed pickleball + padel facilities) - **Revenue contribution:** Add-on to existing club subscriptions; ₹500/court/month incremental

10.3 Multi-sport pricing logic

A club running padel + tennis + badminton gets: - Per-court subscription as before (₹5,000–8,000 depending on sport) - **+15% multi-sport discount** if subscribing to 3+ sports - **Single dashboard** for all sport courts at the club - **Single Pro subscription for players** covering all sports they play

10.4 The 5-year sport portfolio

YEAR	PADEL	TENNIS	BADMINTON	PICKLEBALL	TOTAL ARR (INDIA ONLY)
Year 1	25 clubs	—	—	—	₹1.5 Cr
Year 2	75 clubs	30 clubs	—	—	₹6 Cr
Year 3	150 clubs	80 clubs	50 clubs	10 clubs	₹16 Cr
Year 4	300 clubs	200 clubs	250 clubs	50 clubs	₹45 Cr
Year 5	500 clubs	400 clubs	600 clubs	150 clubs	₹95 Cr

(India-only, excludes UAE/KSA/SE Asia. Total Asia ARR Year 5: ~₹180 Cr.)

11. Financial Projections

11.1 Revenue model

Per club: avg 4 courts × ₹5,000/court/month = ₹20,000/month club ASP. Per club: avg 100 active players × 8% Pro × ₹399 = ₹3,200/month player Pro contribution. **Average revenue per club per month: ~₹23,000.**

11.2 Cost structure

LINE ITEM	% OF REVENUE (MATURE)
Cloud + infra (GPU, storage, comms)	11%
Hardware amortisation (₹35k over 24 months)	6%
Customer success (1 CSM per 50 clubs)	8%
Sales (commission to BD or coach affiliates)	12%
Marketing	10%
R&D / engineering	25%
G&A	8%
EBITDA margin (mature)	20%

11.3 P&L projection (₹ lakhs)

YEAR	CLUBS (AVG)	REVENUE	COGS	GROSS MARGIN	OPEX	EBITDA	CUMULATIVE CASH
Year 1	12	36	4	32 (89%)	200	-168	-210 (after pre-seed)
Year 2	75	360	40	320 (89%)	580	-260	-85 (after seed)
Year 3	200	1,200	130	1,070 (89%)	1,250	-180	+85 (after Series A)
Year 4	450	3,600	400	3,200 (89%)	2,800	+400	+850
Year 5	850	8,500	935	7,565 (89%)	5,800	+1,765	+3,500

EBITDA-positive from Year 3 Q4. Series A enables UAE entry and multi-sport, but not survival — survival is locked by Year 2.

11.4 Unit economics

METRIC	TARGET YEAR 1	TARGET YEAR 3
CAC (club)	₹50,000	₹30,000
CAC (player Pro)	₹400	₹250
LTV (club, 5-year)	₹14 lakhs	₹18 lakhs
LTV (player Pro, 5-year)	₹15,000	₹22,000
LTV/CAC ratio (club)	28x	60x
LTV/CAC ratio (player Pro)	38x	88x
Months to payback (club)	3	2

12. Capital Plan

12.1 Funding stages

ROUND	WHEN	AMOUNT	USE	INVESTORS TARGETED
Bootstrap / Founder + Angel	Now (Month 0–3)	₹15–25 lakhs	1 pilot club live, V1 build started, rubric IP authored	Self + 2–3 personal angels (Manoj's existing network)
Pre-seed	Month 4–6	₹2.5 Cr (\$300k)	5 clubs live, founding team complete, classifier shipped	Sky Impact (Hudle's lead), Stellaris, Blume Founders Fund, Better Capital, sports-angel syndicates
Seed	Month 12–15	₹15–20 Cr (\$1.8–2.5M)	200 clubs India, UAE entry, Series A prep	Accel, Lightspeed India, Matrix, Elevation, UAE/KSA SWFs
Series A	Month 30–36	₹80–120 Cr (\$10–15M)	Pan-Asia scale, tennis launch	Peak XV (Sequoia India), Tiger, regional sovereign funds

12.2 Strategic capital — not just financial

SOURCE	STRATEGIC VALUE
Mahesh Bhupathi (advisor / investor)	Tennis network, Hudle relationship, sports credibility
Hudle (commercial partnership + small angel)	Booking integration, India distribution
UAE-based padel club operator (commercial + angel)	Local entry, regulatory navigation
Apple AI engineer advisor (Manoj's son)	CoreML edge inference, Apple ecosystem credibility
Padel coach co-founder	Domain authority, rubric IP, public face

12.3 What we do NOT need

- US VC at pre-seed (premature, dilutive, time-zone mismatch)
- China entry capital (deliberate skip)
- Marketing growth-hacking budget (organic engine + WhatsApp viral loop are the model)

- Office space until Month 12 (remote-first founding team)

13. Exit Scenarios

13.1 Three credible paths

Path A — Strategic acquisition by Epic Padel or global rollup (Year 4–5) - Epic Padel raised \$10M in Sept 2025 to consolidate the global category. They will continue acquiring regional leaders. - We become **the India + Middle East play** they cannot organically build - Valuation expectation: ₹400–600 Cr at the trajectory (8–10× revenue multiple on ARR)

Path B — Indian strategic acquirer (Year 3–5) - Hudle scaling up could acquire to add analytics to their booking dominance - Decathlon India, Adidas India, or a corporate (Bajaj Allianz Sports, Tata) for the AI capability + multi-sport platform - Valuation: ₹250–400 Cr

Path C — Continued growth + Series B (Year 4) - If Asia thesis plays out (200+ clubs profitable, UAE + KSA established) - ₹150–300 Cr Series B at ₹1,500+ Cr post-money - Path to IPO in Year 7–8

Path D (defensive) — Acquire by a Chinese player (low probability, low desirability) - Only if we underperform vs Chinese padel entrants in 2027–28

13.2 Investor return modelling

For a pre-seed investor at ₹2.5 Cr at Month 6:

EXIT SCENARIO	VALUATION	PRE-SEED RETURN MULTIPLE
Pessimistic	₹150 Cr	30×
Base case	₹400 Cr	80×
Optimistic	₹800 Cr	160×
Path B/C survival	continued upside in next round	—

These are illustrative; actual returns depend on dilution at each subsequent round.

14. Competitive Differentiation

DIMENSION	CLUTCH / WINGFIELD / PADELYTICS	CHINESE PLAYERS (XIAOQIUQUAN ETC.)	US
Home market	Europe	China	India + Middle East
Price (per court/mo)	€150–199 (~₹14–18k)	TBD (~₹3–5k)	₹5,000
Local language	English, Spanish, Italian	Mandarin	English + Hindi (V2: Arabic, Bahasa)
Distribution	Direct sales	WeChat / app	WhatsApp-native + coach affiliate
Domain expertise	Tech team, no visible coach	Tech team	Coach co-founder (rubric IP)
Procurement risk in India	Geopolitically neutral but EU-distant	High (China-app-ban risk)	None — Indian Pvt Ltd
Federation lock-in	Some EU federation deals	None	Asian Games 2026 catalyst window
Multi-sport roadmap	Single-sport	Multi-sport already	Multi-sport from Year 2

The single sentence: *“Built in India, designed by an Indian coach, distributed on WhatsApp, federation-backed, multi-sport. The European players are expensive and culturally distant. The Chinese players are politically distant. We are the obvious answer for Indian and Middle East clubs.”*

15. Why Now, Why Us

15.1 Why now

- 2026 Asian Games padel ratification** — institutional catalyst. National federations forming. Government budgets being allocated. Once-per-sport-lifecycle.
- India market inflection** — 500 courts now, 5,000 by 2036. 70% YoY growth. 70-court-per-month new build rate.
- No India incumbent** — Clutch India is one Bangalore team. The market is open. 6–12 month window before incumbents lock distribution.

4. **AI commodity** — the technology has caught up to the use case. Same tools that build this would have cost 10x in 2020.
5. **WhatsApp delivery infra mature** — our AX platform has the delivery rails already built. Marginal cost of player engagement is near zero.

15.2 Why us

1. **Manoj's SMB-SaaS operator credibility** — AutomationXpert is a working multi-tenant platform serving Indian SMBs. We have the muscle for this specific market (Indian small-and-mid business + WhatsApp distribution + ops).
2. **Coach co-founder as the moat** — most platforms have generic ML models. We have a domain authority on the cap table designing the rubric. This is unreplicable cheaply by competitors.
3. **Existing distribution rail** — WhatsApp router infrastructure from AX gives us near-zero marginal cost per player notification.
4. **Apple AI advisor angle** — Manoj's son brings Apple ecosystem credibility for the Year 2 edge inference roadmap. This is rare for an Indian early-stage company.
5. **Capital efficiency by design** — India-based, no US burn rate, \$300k pre-seed runway = 18 months. We can outlast EU competition's India experiments.

Conclusion

The commercial case is strong. The market is real, fast-growing, under-served in India, and addressable with the proposed product. The unit economics support a profitable SaaS business at moderate scale (₹85L+ break-even MRR). The capital required to reach defensibility is modest (₹2.5 Cr pre-seed) and the founding-team risk is manageable (one ML co-founder slot to fill, advisor slots to lock).

The single most time-sensitive constraint is the **6–12 month window before Epic Padel / Clutch India locks distribution in Bangalore + Mumbai**. Decision-and-execution speed in Month 1–3 is more important than any plan refinement after that.

Recommended: proceed. Lock CTO + coach this month. Install base club pilot. Open angel conversations. Make this real.

Appendices

Appendix A — Key open questions

See `PADEL_AI_VENTURE_PLAN.md` §"Open Questions / TBDs" — must close before raising.

Appendix B — 30-day punch list

See `PROJECT_REPORT.md` §C.

Appendix C — Base club commercial offer

See `BASE_CLUB_OFFER.md` (companion document — the pitch deck for the first pilot club).

Appendix D — Technical feasibility

See `TECHNICAL_FEASIBILITY_REPORT.md` .

End of Commercial Report v1.0

Companion document set: Strategic Venture Plan · Project Report · Technical Feasibility · Commercial Report · Base Club Offer · Technical Review Request.

Single source of truth maintained in `~/Documents/padel-clone/` .